

ShieldAI

The virtual CISO every small business can finally afford.

Derrick Brooks · Founder & CEO · Xandu Limited, LLC

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Every business is a target. Almost none can afford protection.

\$200K–\$400K

Cost of a full-time CISO, per year

47%

Small businesses with zero cybersecurity budget

99%

of US businesses are small or mid-sized

Yet insurers, customers, and regulators now require a real security program — *there is no small-business exemption from the threat landscape.*

The pressure just became unavoidable.

1

Cyber-insurance as gatekeeper

63% of SMBs saw premiums rise 200%+ in 2025; insurers now require proof of MFA and incident response before issuing or renewing a policy.

2

Customer-driven requirements

Larger customers push security questionnaires and insurance requirements down to small vendors — no program, no contract.

3

Expanding regulation

HIPAA, CMMC, the FTC Safeguards Rule, and state privacy laws now carry real penalties, reaching deep into the small-business tier.

4

AI made the cost collapse

Expert-level security analysis is now deliverable at \$0.28 per client per month — the segment is finally economically servable.

An honest look at the landscape.

Company	Buyer	Price / yr	Gap vs. ShieldAI
Cynomi	MSP / MSSP	Not sold to SMB	Sells only through service providers
Vanta	VC-funded tech co.	\$10K–\$80K+	No engineer review; not SMB-priced
Drata	VC-funded tech co.	\$7.5K–\$100K+	Built for cloud-native engineering teams
Secureframe	VC-funded tech co.	\$7.5K–\$80K+	Guided audit prep, not a full CISO program
Scrut Automation	Mid-market SaaS	\$15K–\$40K	Requires in-house GRC expertise

Every well-funded name in the category sells through an MSP channel or to venture-funded tech companies at 4–50x ShieldAI's price. Full profiles in the companion Competitive Analysis.

A virtual CISO, powered by AI, overseen by engineers.

- A continuous security program — not a one-time PDF that sits in a drawer
- A real, defensible security score, mapped to NIST CSF and CIS Controls v8.1
- Ready-to-use policies, a prioritized roadmap, training, and compliance tracking
- Priced as a subscription — not a consulting engagement

BEFORE

A drawer PDF from a one-time consulting engagement

AFTER

A living program that scores, updates, and reports on its own — reviewed by a real engineer

Assess → Score → Generate → Monitor → Manage

1

Assess

Conversational intake +
structured checklist across
NIST, CIS v8.1, HIPAA, PCI,
SOC 2

2

Score

Deterministic NIST CSF
engine — not AI guesswork

3

Generate

Policies, roadmap, training,
compliance gap analysis,
executive report

4

Monitor

Optional read-only endpoint
agent (Windows / Linux /
macOS) reports live posture

5

Manage

Continuous oversight +
expert engineer review

Live in production — not slideware.

- Conversational assessment

- Deterministic NIST scoring

- 12 compliance frameworks

- Policy generation (Word export)

- Prioritized roadmap

- Awareness training product

- Executive reporting

- 5-tier billing, live

- Read-only monitoring agent

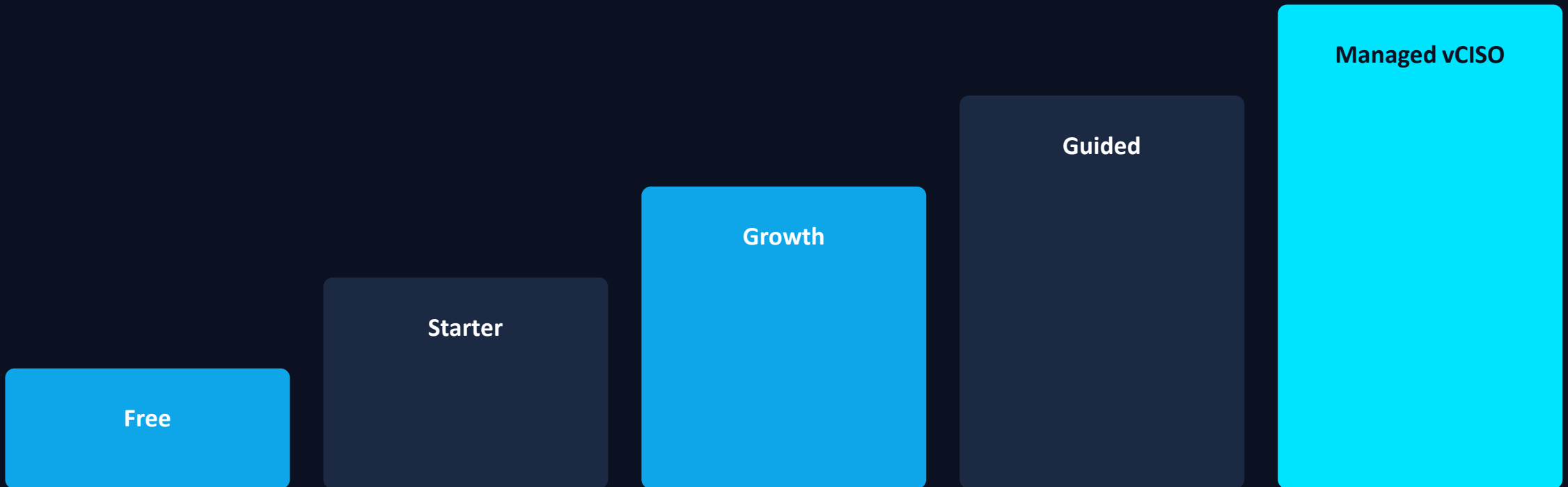
- Analyst console (mockup)

- Mastermind AI co-pilot

- Admin & audit tooling

Client walkthrough: demo@shieldai.com · Platform view: analyst@xandultd.com

Land free. Expand to self-serve.
Grow into managed programs.



Free assessment removes all friction at the door; each stage adds engineer time and recurring value.

Recurring revenue that grows with the relationship.

Free	Starter	Growth	Guided	Managed vCISO
\$0	\$159	\$349	\$699	\$1,950
/month	/month	/month	/month	/month
Assessment & score	Full program, no engineer time	Expanded coverage + training access	+ periodic engineer review	Engineer runs the program end-to-end

+ \$40/mo training delivery add-on for Starter — bundled free at Growth tier and above. Measured AI cost: \$0.28/client/month.

Undercuts traditional human-only vCISO retainers (\$2,500–\$11,600/mo) at every tier.

A large, underserved market being forced to act.



TAM — the vCISO category ShieldAI directly serves



SAM — regulated / insured / supply-chain SMB segment



SOM — realistic early capture over 3–5 years

5.8M

US employer businesses (36.2M total)

3.4M

unfilled cybersecurity roles globally

Not a wrapper. A defensible system — already built.

1

Deterministic, explainable scoring

A NIST CSF posture score an insurer or auditor can trust — not an opaque AI guess.

2

Human-in-the-loop delivery

A qualified engineer reviews every deliverable — a layer no self-serve compliance platform offers at any price.

3

Compounding data & relationships

Every assessment and managed client makes the system smarter and stickier.

4

Direct-to-SMB reach, at an SMB price

The lane Cynomi, Vanta, Drata, Secureframe, and Scrut Automation have all left structurally open.

Why I'm the one to build this.

Derrick Brooks

Founder & CEO, Xandu Limited, LLC

- ~20 years of cybersecurity experience spanning national-security roles, enterprise CISO work, and hands-on SMB delivery
- Navy Lieutenant Commander; offensive security practitioner
- Zero Trust / Azure implementation experience with real client outcomes
- Credentials: CISSP, CISM, CompTIA Security+
- Dual M.S. in Cybersecurity (National University); MBA in IT Management (SNHU); doctorate in progress (Westcliff University)

AI is nearly free. Engineer time is the real cost.

Managed vCISO — Per Engineer

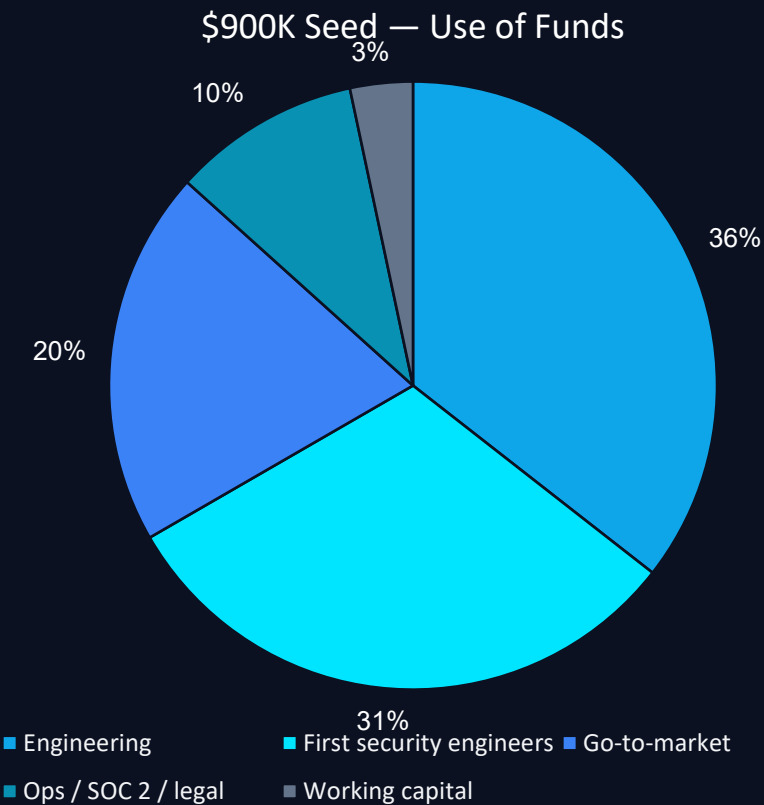
Price	\$1,950 / month
Clients per engineer	~25
Revenue per engineer / yr	~\$585,000
Loaded engineer cost / yr	~\$140,000
AI cost per engineer / yr	~\$84
Contribution margin	~76%

Blended company-wide margin expands as headcount is absorbed by a growing client book:



What this raise unlocks.

- Live Today**
Full client product, 12 frameworks, 5-tier billing, monitoring agent
- This Raise**
Analyst console to live; hire first security engineers; Mastermind in production
- Then**
Agent telemetry, automated alerting, channel partnerships, expand client base



\$900,000

Seed round to build the managed-security platform layer
and take ShieldAI to Series A readiness in 22–24 months.

“A full-time CISO costs a quarter-million dollars a year. ShieldAI delivers that protection for the price of a subscription — and lets a handful of our engineers protect thousands of businesses.”

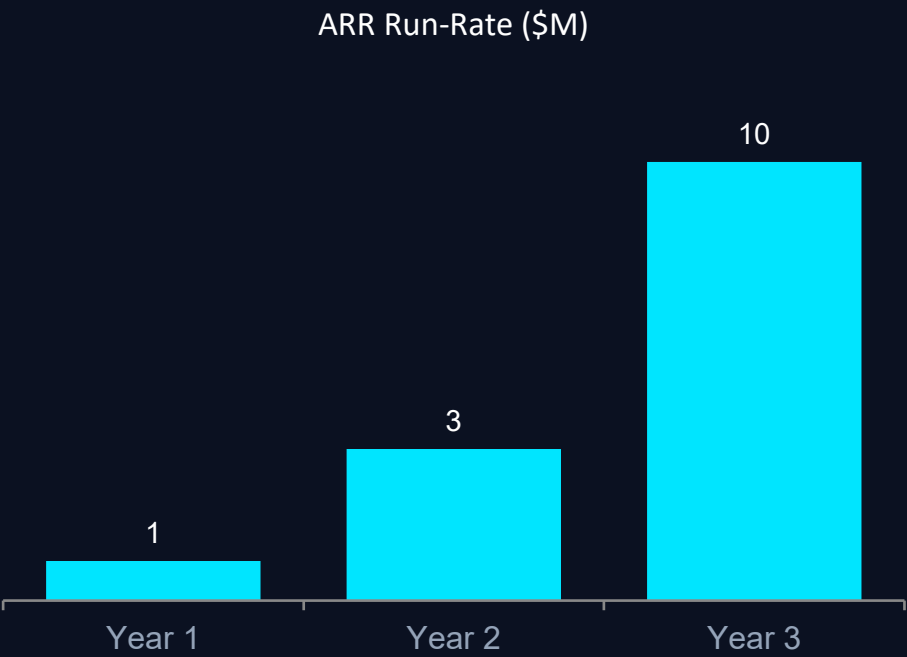
An abstract graphic consisting of four cyan dots. One dot is at the top center. Two dots are positioned horizontally below it, one to the left and one to the right. A fourth dot is located below the left dot, connected to it by a thin cyan line. From this fourth dot, another thin cyan line extends horizontally to the right, passing through the dot that sits directly above the word 'APPENDIX'.

APPENDIX

Backup detail for investor Q&A

A 3-year plan built from a full monthly model.

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Total paying clients	170	610	1,610
Team headcount	5	13	23
ARR (year-end run-rate)	~\$0.9M	~\$3.5M	~\$10.1M
Gross margin	~12%	~58%	~74%
EBITDA margin	~(147)%	~2%	~44%



The \$900K raise is never fully exhausted under this plan — modeled cash bottoms out around \$130K near Month 18, then turns cash-flow positive.

Two boundaries we will not cross.



Human-in-the-loop, always

Every client-facing deliverable is reviewed and approved by a qualified engineer before it ships. AI accelerates the work; it never replaces judgment or accountability.



Analyst isolation

Each engineer's console access is scoped strictly to their assigned clients — no cross-client visibility, enforced at the platform level.



Agents are permanently read-only

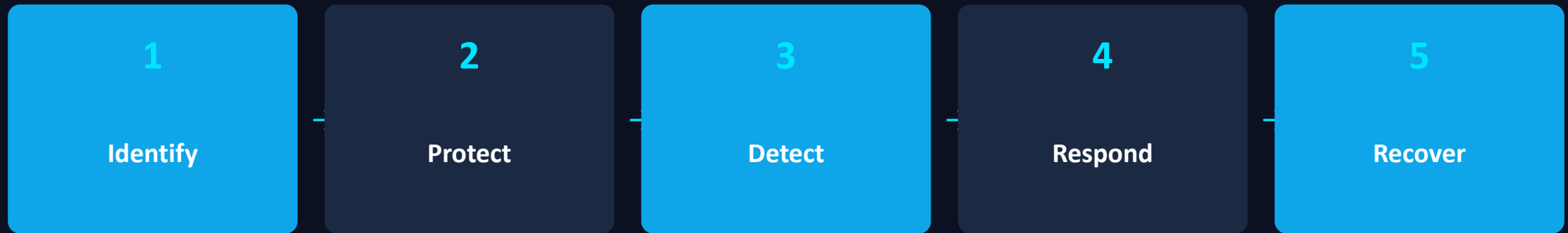
Monitoring agents report posture and telemetry only. There is no inbound command channel — an agent cannot act on a client's environment, ever.



Mastermind is advisory only

The AI co-pilot triages, diagnoses, and surfaces gaps for the engineer. It cannot take action on a client's behalf under any circumstance.

A deterministic engine, not an AI guess.



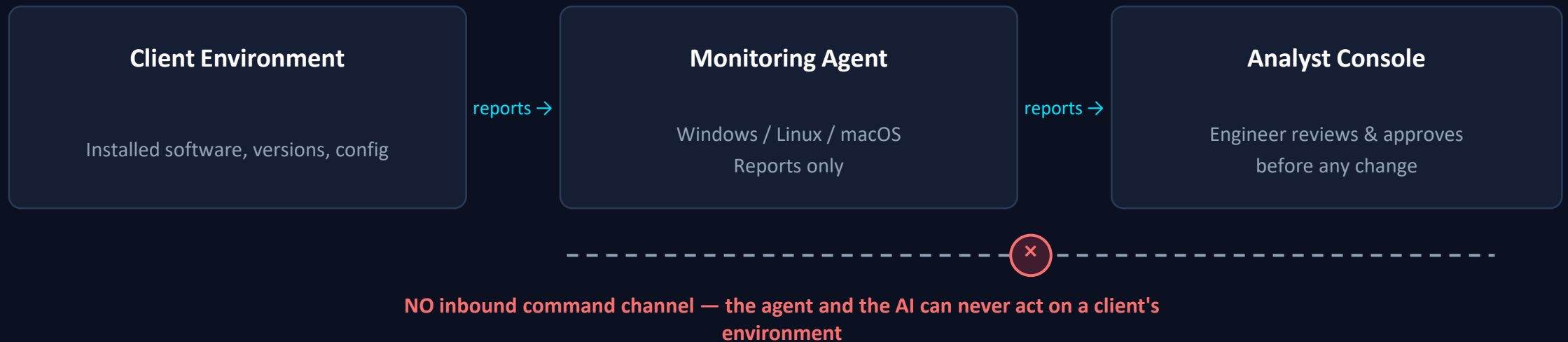
The NIST Cybersecurity Framework's five functions, each weighted and scored from the structured assessment. **The same inputs always produce the same score, and every point traces to a specific control** — which is why insurers and auditors can trust it in a way they'd never trust an opaque AI output. CIS Controls v8.1 mapping is supported alongside NIST CSF.

The full ladder, what's enforced at each tier.

Tier	Price	What's included
Free	\$0	Security assessment and posture score only
Starter	\$159/mo	Full program generation, policy library, endpoint monitoring — no engineer time
Growth	\$349/mo	Expanded policy & endpoint coverage, full training program access, downloads/exports
Guided	\$699/mo	Growth, plus periodic engineer review, compliance tracking, and check-ins
Managed vCISO	\$1,950/mo	A ShieldAI engineer runs the security program end-to-end

Plus a \$40/month training delivery add-on for Starter — bundled free at Growth tier and above.

The read-only agent boundary.



Only a client admin or a permitted, isolated analyst can make a change — never the agent, never the AI, unilaterally.